

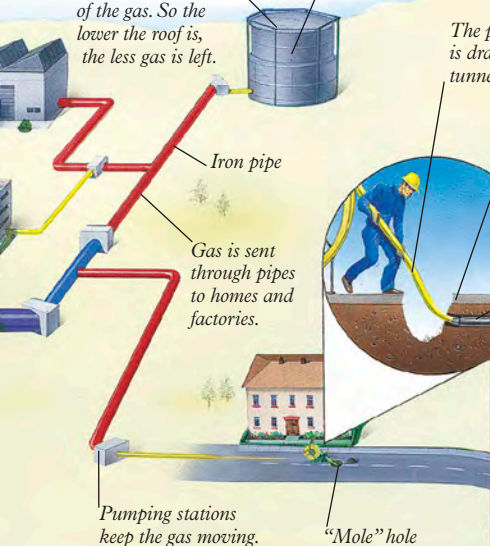


On the way up

This big building, called a rig, gathers up gas that flows from deep under the sea bed. The drill to reach the pocket of gas may be nearly four miles (six kilometers) long.

Some gas is stored near homes to supply sudden daily demands—such as at dinner time!

The roof floats on top of the gas. So the lower the roof is, the less gas is left.



The plastic gas pipe is dragged through the tunnel by the "mole."

Road

The "mole" smashes through the earth like a pneumatic drill.



"Mole" hole



Growing gas

Farms off the coast of California grow a giant seaweed called kelp. It is harvested three times a year by special ships and then put in tanks and left to rot. The decaying kelp gives off methane gas.

Moles beat diggers

Small pipes can be laid without digging up streets by using a rocketlike machine called a "mole." Its route is guided by a computer.

What size pipe?



You could stand up in the pipe that travels between the rig and the terminal.



A dog could fit into the pipe that links factory pipes to gas-terminal pipes.



The pipes that take gas to factories is roomy enough for a cat to sit in.



A mouse could fit into the small plastic pipe that goes into your home.